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As of my last knowledge update in September 2021, the "Airbnb problem" typically refers to the challenges and controversies associated with short-term rental platforms like Airbnb. Some common issues include:

1. **Regulation and Compliance:** One of the major issues is the regulation of short-term rentals. Many cities and municipalities have struggled to regulate Airbnb rentals, often due to concerns about the impact on housing availability, affordability, noise, safety, and the character of neighborhoods.
2. **Housing Affordability:** Critics argue that the rise of Airbnb has contributed to housing shortages in some cities by converting long-term rental units into short-term vacation rentals. This can drive up housing prices and make it harder for local residents to find affordable housing.
3. **Community Disruption:** Airbnb rentals can sometimes disrupt residential neighborhoods by bringing in transient guests who may not be as invested in the community as long-term residents. Issues like noise, partying, and safety concerns can arise from short-term rentals.
4. **Taxation:** There are concerns about the tax implications of Airbnb rentals. Hosts are often responsible for collecting and remitting occupancy taxes, but compliance can be inconsistent, leading to potential revenue losses for local governments.
5. **Quality and Safety:** Another problem is ensuring the quality and safety of Airbnb accommodations. While many hosts provide excellent service, there have been instances of misrepresented listings, safety hazards, and unhygienic conditions.
6. **Data Privacy and Security:** Concerns have been raised about data privacy and security on short-term rental platforms like Airbnb. Guests and hosts may be sharing personal information that could be vulnerable to breaches or misuse.

It's important to note that the situation may have evolved since my last update, and I recommend checking more recent sources for the latest information on the challenges associated with Airbnb and other short-term rental platforms.

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What are some cities that have implemented policies related to short-term rentals?



Can you give me an example of a problem that arose from short-term rentals?



What are the common proposals to regulate short-term rentals?



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Boat builder · 2y



Originally Answered: What are the disadvantages of Airbnb?

We love Airbnb, both as busy hosts, and as keen travelling guests. Great way of experiencing new cultures, meeting new people, travelling the world.

But it is not all good news. Some cities have become unaffordable for local people to live in, because Airbnb hosts have bought up all the suitable housing.

It isn't easy to make money as a host. So many costs to meet, and so much time you need to devote to liaising with guests, meeting guests, cleaning after guests, preparing for new guests, repairing, maintaining, adapting.. Many cities, notably London, have sought to mitigate against the rise in ... ([more](#))



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What problem is Airbnb solving?

What was the creative solution for the problem that was identified by Airbnb?

What is the number 1 problem with Airbnb?

How safe is Airbnb?

How can Airbnb be improved?

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Jeff Kirk · Follow



Ex-pro hotel critic, current law-degreed Airbnb Superhost · 2y

Originally Answered: What is the number 1 problem with Airbnb?

I don't think I can limit this to a single answer, in part because it varies depending on whose perspective it reflects. Speaking as a host, I'd say Airbnb's biggest problem is refusing to sufficiently "verify" the IDs of its guests. Yes, they check if a given ID is *valid*, but – unlike, say, Sonder or other "boutique STR" startups – they don't run background checks on guests using said ID.

That's more or less how I ended up hosting a two-time felon who trashed one of my units & damaged thousands of dollars' worth of property. After the damage was done, I looked up his rap sheet myself, and suffice it to say it was lengthy, with two outstanding warrants for his arrest on *felony* charges. (And ever since then I've done my own checks of guests' backgrounds when they strike me as fishy, e.g. they have zero reviews from other hosts or are likely to be "partiers" who might similarly trash the place. Airbnb allows hosts to cancel if they "feel uncomfortable" with any prospective guest, and I definitely feel uncomfortable allowing, say, a group of six guys throw a bachelor party in my 1BR condo. (True story btw – I rejected that booking.)

If you're a guest, you might think the biggest problem is the exorbitant increase in prices over the past six months in most places. While this is certainly true, it's due in significant part to Airbnb losing 40% of its total units as a result of the pandemic (mainly due to hosts being unable to keep up with their mortgage payments in the absence of steady side income). It's also a basic market reality: many hosts, myself included, price units based on the area's prevailing average, and in my case it's more than doubled since this time last year (and, unlike most hosts, I did reasonably well even in 2020, though I had no choice but to rent out my units at below-cost – OTOH none of them had mortgages, so I could cover the shortfalls before the travel sector came roaring back).

If you're the head of a local neighborhood association – not counting HOAs, in this case – the biggest Airbnb problem might be (or assumed to be) "party houses": single-family homes rented out, usually illegally, to large groups that invariably use them for very loud, very long parties lasting well into the night. (That said, there's a difference between genuine concern in this area & basic NIMBYism, and most NA complaints I've seen fall into the latter category.)

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Nicolas Le Roux · Follow



Works at La Langue Française (2015–present) · 9y

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What problem is Airbnb solving?

Airbnb solves 2 problems :

1. It's not easy for travelers to find a nice place to stay in the cities for a fair price
2. It's becoming hard to afford the rent when you live in a city and AirBnB allows you to get an extra money to pay the rent

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I feel obliged here to give some warnings to women who travel alone and decide to stay in Airbnb or any kind of private rentals: stay vigilant.

I was trusting of other people before I had this incident. I used Airbnb during my Hawaii trip in December 2015. My overall experience was pleasant until I met host R. Oconner in the northwest of Oahu Island, where the nightmare started. Like other hosts, he tried to establish rapport with me by talking and sharing his hobbies with me. I was unguarded after staying with him for two days. We connected on FB and I revealed my personal information and trip plans to him, getting suggestions and recommendations. So when he offered to meet me in Maui Island (my next stop after Oahu) and to give me a tour while he was there for the holidays, I gladly accepted. I gave him a five-star review on Airbnb, and I also give him a ride to the Airport the day I left his place. However, after meeting him in Maui, he took me to his friend's house in the woods, and sexually assaulted me that night. I was able to get rid of him later and stayed in a Hostel the rest of days. I didn't report this to the police until one day prior to my departure of Maui, intimidated by the thought that he might come after me since he knew where I was staying.

The story doesn't have a happy ending. Like 90% of sexual assault cases, the detective who was assigned to my case didn't even get statements from the offender or his friend involved in the case, because he said it was a "he said she said case". I felt the humiliation and rage I had when I gave my statement describing the details were consumed. In thinking back, it was so obvious that it was premeditated, and I wasn't smart enough to read the hints until it was too late. He made sure that I gave him a good review before he did anything bad to me, so he wouldn't harass any people during their official stays; He asked me to share the expense of a rental car he used in Maui before he did anything bad, for he did not have to assume any economic loss; he acted like a friend and added me on FB, but removed me from FB and blocked my phone number soon after the attack, etc.. I would not know he was ill-intended without this experience. As a host, he has a decent job and owns a nice townhouse and a car, doing a part-time master's degree, just like any aspiring professionals I would meet in the city. How could I tell?

Moreover, I could not revise my Airbnb review to warn incoming female guests to his place. I submitted a report about the host to Airbnb but never heard back from them. To be fair, Airbnb is just a middleman between hosts and guests. Safety responsibility lies on each individual.

Just keep in mind that, if traveling alone as a female, try to stay with a female host or a couple. Airbnb reviews are not always reliable since most of the reviews are five stars. It is really hard to use them to screen hosts.

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1 of 93 answers

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who were willing to put in some equity to have a really nice place. These are highly unusual rooms with A plus features. But people have to give back in some way.

Airbnb does not play an active role in charity. The hosts do. We are the ones giving away free rooms to flood survivors. We house beaten women and recovering addicts and people who are disabled. Not Airbnb.

Sooner or later, all of us face choices. What d... [\(more\)](#)

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Originally Answered: What is the number 1 problem with Airbnb?

What is the number 1 problem with Airbnb?

Our biggest problem as hosts is with guests who don't READ the listing. We make it very clear - as in, repeating it several times in the listing - that these are two private ROOMS in the boss' home. She lives there full time. And yet we still have people show up thinking they booked the entire house for \$80/night.

The other biggest problem is the last minute "Do you mind if we add one more person" requests. Again, our listing is VERY clear that there are three beds, with a total guest potential of 6 people. That's all. And yet, at least once a month, the... [\(more\)](#)

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Originally Answered: What is the disadvantage of Airbnb?

- There are some minor disadvantage are there-
- You May Not Get What You See
- No Space To Leave Your Luggage
- Hosts Can Cancel
- Added Charges
- Potential Damage
- Possible Legal Issues

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Founder - helping expats and HNWIs invest and protect wealth · Updated May 23

How can you make money grow and invest while working abroad?

Most of the same fundamentals exist as if you are investing back home, but I will deal with some caveats later in the answer.

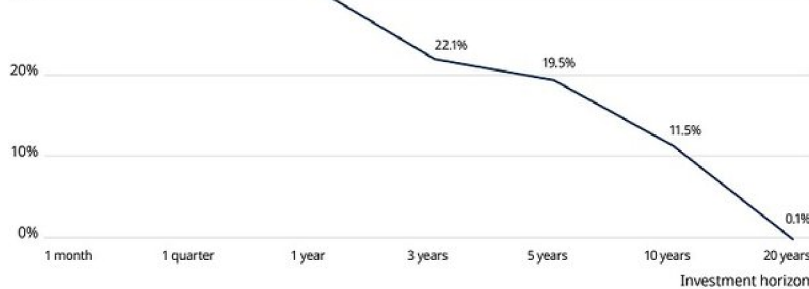
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- Invest for the long-term. This will compound your gains and reduce your risk



Past performance is not a guide to the future and may not be repeated
Source: Robert Shiller, Schrodgers. Analysis based on rolling periods for S&P 500 index. Data January 1871-March 2020.

- Invest and not speculate. A long-term, sensible plan is always likely to beat trying to get into short-term trends. We have seen that in recent years, many people have been getting into meme stocks at inflated prices.
- As an expat who might relocate, you need a portable solution as you move around the world - [Apply now for a portable, expat-focused, investment](#)

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Related **What problem is Airbnb solving?**

Providing a reliable, disintermediating global platform for matching supply and demand in the temporary housing and lodging market.

They were initially doing two things: solving a cheap lodging problem (cheap hotels in San Francisco full and overbooked during a design conference in 2007) and finding an auxiliary revenue stream, because they couldn't afford the rent on their apartment.

Classic case of entrepreneurs solving a problem they struggled with and then making a market out of it.

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Related **What problem is Airbnb solving?**

Airbnb allows you to stay with local families, individuals, or couples to see what it is really like to live in a city. It creates a platform where a "home-stay" can be arranged easily, efficiently, and with more reviews/experiences from previous guests.

Normally when I travel, in order to stay in the style of living with a local family at a homestay, I must commit to a longer period of time, say a month, but with Airbnb I can just stay for an evening.

It also provides entire homes/apts so that you can live in a space more like a local too.

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Related **What is the #1 problem for Airbnb & vacation rental hosts?**

I'll bite. It's people who endlessly want to negotiate. My place is in Hawaii in a very expensive area. The HOA fees are \$1200 a month. I have top of the line construction and furnishings. Renters should expect to pay accordingly. I'm not here to subsidize your vacation. You may be a lovely person but I still don't want to haggle with you via email for hours unless you are bringing something to the table in return. It's respectful to pay the posted rates and not harangue me for cheap rates like a hotel.

Mellie Hane · Follow

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Related **How does Airbnb work?**

message the property host and ask some general questions regarding the accommodation and their price tags. And if you're happy with the answers, you can go ahead with the reservation.

Now here comes the big ... [\(more\)](#)

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Absolutely not Definitely yes

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2

2



Related **What is the #1 problem for Airbnb & vacation rental hosts?**

They are becoming cannon fodder in Airbnb's epic battle to overtake Priceline as the leader in global hospitality as Airbnb focuses more on small-scale hoteliers and multi-property superhosts at the expense of mom & pop single-property hosts. (These multi-property superhosts generate an astounding [40%+ of Airbnb's revenue](#) despite making up less than [5% of listings](#) in some markets)

Despite Airbnb's claims to the contrary (they tell hosts on their site that there is "[so much more than money](#)"), they have a dirty little secret: it's ALL about the money for them at this point. Outside big money Sili... [\(more\)](#)

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1



Related **What is the #1 problem for Airbnb & vacation rental hosts?**

1. Dealing with legal issues/regulations. Not knowing what is required from them, or how to fulfill those requirements.
2. I would assume guests - some guests aren't easy. Turnover is usually the hardest part (cleaning up after them).
3. General problems that most hosts/investment property owners have:
 - a. Not having a positive cash flow
 - b. Experiencing a low Airbnb occupancy rate, like you mentioned.

Here are some blogs that might help each of these issues:

1. [Cities With The Least Airbnb Legal Issues](#)
2. [How to Streamline the Post-Guest Process for Your Investment Rental Property](#)
3. [How To Have A Positive Cash Flow Income Pr](#)

... [\(more\)](#)

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1



Related **What are Airbnb's biggest flaws?**

I'll start by saying I had several good AirBnB stays before I went to Los Angeles for my nephew's wedding.

But for that occasion, I had TWO last-minute cancellations that were a nightmare, taking up my last day vacationing with a friend in Marin County. I gave up and paid hotel prices near the airport. I wrote and mailed *certified* mail a letter about the situation to CEO Brian Chesky (figuring someone in his office would answer). USPS tracking says it was delivered, but I never received a reply.

I spent hours the day before my reservation dealing with my next-night L.A. AirBnB's last minute canc... [\(more\)](#)

2 answers collapsed (Why?)

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